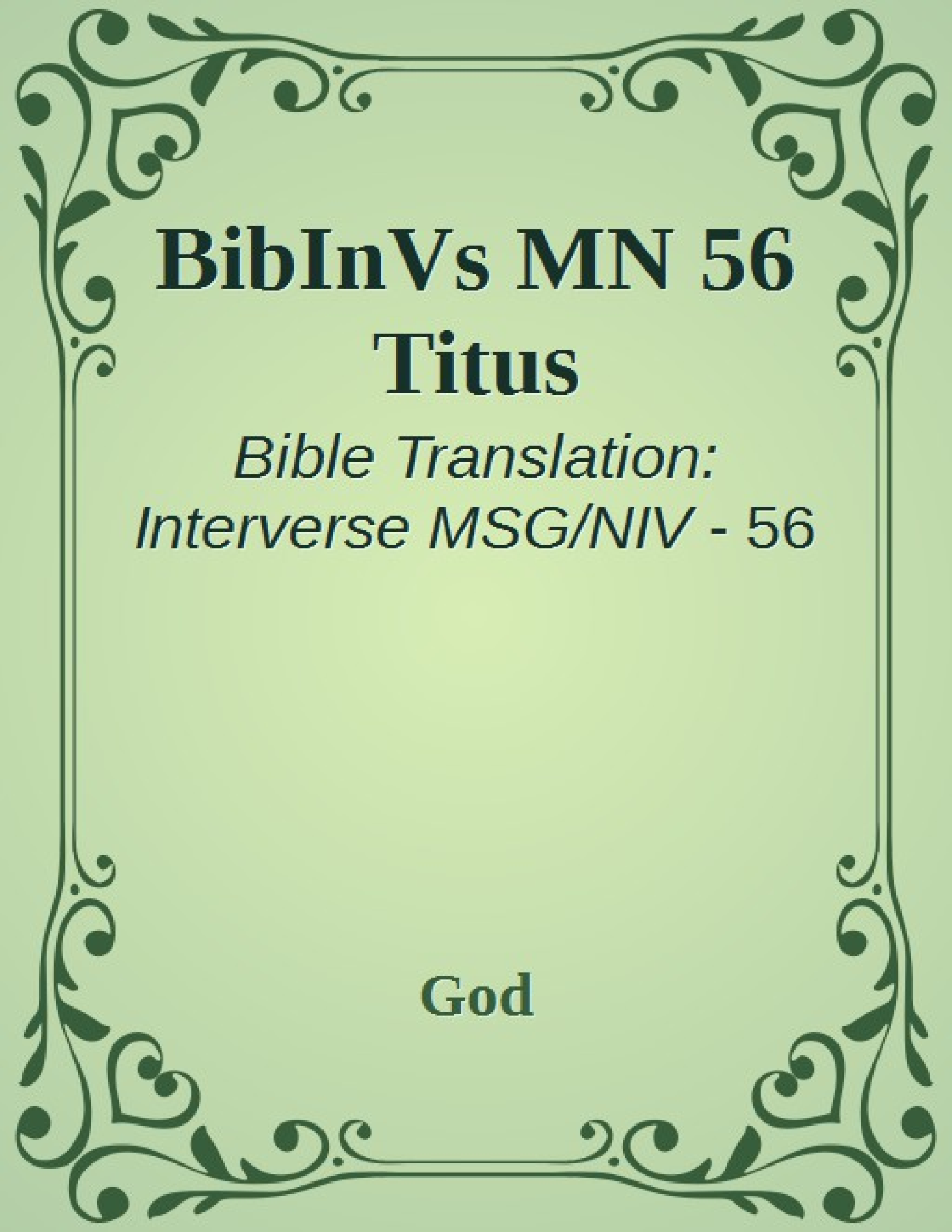


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 56

Titus

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 56*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Titus

Titus 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 I, Paul, am God's slave and Christ's agent for promoting the faith among God's chosen people, getting out the accurate word on God and how to respond rightly to it.
- 1 Paul, a servant of God and an apostle of Jesus Christ for the faith of God's elect and the knowledge of the truth that leads to godliness--
- 2 My aim is to raise hopes by pointing the way to life without end. This is the life God promised long ago--and he doesn't break promises!
- 2 a faith and knowledge resting on the hope of eternal life, which God, who does not lie, promised before the beginning of time,
- 3 And then when the time was ripe, he went public with his truth. I've been entrusted to proclaim this Message by order of our Savior, God himself.
- 3 and at his appointed season he brought his word to light through the preaching entrusted to me by the command of God our Savior,
- 4 Dear Titus, legitimate son in the faith: Receive everything God our Father and Jesus our Savior give you!
- 4 To Titus, my true son in our common faith: Grace and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Savior.
- 5 I left you in charge in Crete so you could complete what I left half-done. Appoint leaders in every town according to my instructions.
- 5 The reason I left you in Crete was that you might straighten out what was left unfinished and appoint elders in every town, as I directed you.
- 6 As you select them, ask, "Is this man well-thought-of? Are his children believers? Do they respect him and stay out of trouble?"
- 6 An elder must be blameless, the husband of but one wife, a man whose children believe and are not open to the charge of being wild and disobedient.

- 7 It's important that a church leader, responsible for the affairs in God's house, be looked up to--not pushy, not short-tempered, not a drunk, not a bully, not money-hungry.
- 7 Since an overseer is entrusted with God's work, he must be blameless--not overbearing, not quick-tempered, not given to drunkenness, not violent, not pursuing dishonest gain.
- 8 He must welcome people, be helpful, wise, fair, reverent, have a good grip on himself,
- 8 Rather he must be hospitable, one who loves what is good, who is self-controlled, upright, holy and disciplined.
- 9 and have a good grip on the Message, knowing how to use the truth to either spur people on in knowledge or stop them in their tracks if they oppose it.
- 9 He must hold firmly to the trustworthy message as it has been taught, so that he can encourage others by sound doctrine and refute those who oppose it.
- 10 For there are a lot of rebels out there, full of loose, confusing, and deceiving talk. Those who were brought up religious and ought to know better are the worst.
- 10 For there are many rebellious people, mere talkers and deceivers, especially those of the circumcision group.
- 11 They've got to be shut up. They're disrupting entire families with their teaching, and all for the sake of a fast buck.
- 11 They must be silenced, because they are ruining whole households by teaching things they ought not to teach--and that for the sake of dishonest gain.
- 12 One of their own prophets said it best: The Cretans are liars from the womb, barking dogs, lazy bellies.
- 12 Even one of their own prophets has said, "Cretans are always liars, evil brutes, lazy gluttons."
- 13 He certainly spoke the truth. Get on them right away. Stop that diseased talk of Jewish make-believe and made-up rules
- 13 This testimony is true. Therefore, rebuke them sharply, so that they will be sound in the faith
- 14 so they can recover a robust faith.

- 14 and will pay no attention to Jewish myths or to the commands of those who reject the truth.
- 15 Everything is clean to the clean-minded; nothing is clean to dirty-minded unbelievers. They leave their dirty fingerprints on every thought and act.
- 15 To the pure, all things are pure, but to those who are corrupted and do not believe, nothing is pure. In fact, both their minds and consciences are corrupted.
- 16 They say they know God, but their actions speak louder than their words. They're real creeps, disobedient good-for-nothings.
- 16 They claim to know God, but by their actions they deny him. They are detestable, disobedient and unfit for doing anything good.

Titus 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Your job is to speak out on the things that make for solid doctrine.
- 1 You must teach what is in accord with sound doctrine.
- 2 Guide older men into lives of temperance, dignity, and wisdom, into healthy faith, love, and endurance.
- 2 Teach the older men to be temperate, worthy of respect, self-controlled, and sound in faith, in love and in endurance.
- 3 Guide older women into lives of reverence so they end up as neither gossips nor drunks, but models of goodness.
- 3 Likewise, teach the older women to be reverent in the way they live, not to be slanderers or addicted to much wine, but to teach what is good.
- 4 By looking at them, the younger women will know how to love their husbands and children,
- 4 Then they can train the younger women to love their husbands and children,
- 5 be virtuous and pure, keep a good house, be good wives. We don't want anyone looking down on God's Message because of their behavior.
- 5 to be self-controlled and pure, to be busy at home, to be kind, and to be subject to their husbands, so that no one will malign the word of God.
- 6 Also, guide the young men to live disciplined lives.

- 6 Similarly, encourage the young men to be self-controlled.
- 7 But mostly, show them all this by doing it yourself, incorruptible in your teaching,
- 7 In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching show integrity, seriousness
- 8 your words solid and sane. Then anyone who is dead set against us, when he finds nothing weird or misguided, might eventually come around.
- 8 and soundness of speech that cannot be condemned, so that those who oppose you may be ashamed because they have nothing bad to say about us.
- 9 Guide slaves into being loyal workers, a bonus to their masters--no back talk,
- 9 Teach slaves to be subject to their masters in everything, to try to please them, not to talk back to them,
- 10 no petty thievery. Then their good character will shine through their actions, adding luster to the teaching of our Savior God.
- 10 and not to steal from them, but to show that they can be fully trusted, so that in every way they will make the teaching about God our Savior attractive.
- 11 God's readiness to give and forgive is now public. Salvation's available for everyone!
- 11 For the grace of God that brings salvation has appeared to all men.
- 12 We're being shown how to turn our backs on a godless, indulgent life, and how to take on a God-filled, God-honoring life. This new life is starting right now,
- 12 It teaches us to say "No" to ungodliness and worldly passions, and to live self-controlled, upright and godly lives in this present age,
- 13 and is whetting our appetites for the glorious day when our great God and Savior, Jesus Christ, appears.
- 13 while we wait for the blessed hope--the glorious appearing of our great God and Savior, Jesus Christ,
- 14 He offered himself as a sacrifice to free us from a dark, rebellious life into this good, pure life, making us a people he can be proud of, energetic in goodness.
- 14 who gave himself for us to redeem us from all wickedness and to purify for himself a people that are his very own, eager to do what is good.

- 15 Tell them all this. Build up their courage, and discipline them if they get out of line. You're in charge. Don't let anyone put you down.
- 15 These, then, are the things you should teach. Encourage and rebuke with all authority. Do not let anyone despise you.

Titus 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Remind the people to respect the government and be law-abiding, always ready to lend a helping hand
- 1 Remind the people to be subject to rulers and authorities, to be obedient, to be ready to do whatever is good,
- 2 No insults, no fights. God's people should be bighearted and courteous.
- 2 to slander no one, to be peaceable and considerate, and to show true humility toward all men.
- 3 It wasn't so long ago that we ourselves were stupid and stubborn, dupes of sin, ordered every which way by our glands, going around with a chip on our shoulder, hated and hating back.
- 3 At one time we too were foolish, disobedient, deceived and enslaved by all kinds of passions and pleasures. We lived in malice and envy, being hated and hating one another.
- 4 But when God, our kind and loving Savior God, stepped in,
- 4 But when the kindness and love of God our Savior appeared,
- 5 he saved us from all that. It was all his doing; we had nothing to do with it. He gave us a good bath, and we came out of it new people, washed inside and out by the Holy Spirit.
- 5 he saved us, not because of righteous things we had done, but because of his mercy. He saved us through the washing of rebirth and renewal by the Holy Spirit,
- 6 Our Savior Jesus poured out new life so generously.
- 6 whom he poured out on us generously through Jesus Christ our Savior,
- 7 God's gift has restored our relationship with him and given us back our lives. And there's more life to come--an eternity of life!
- 7 so that, having been justified by his grace, we might become heirs having the hope of eternal life.

- 8 You can count on this. I want you to put your foot down. Take a firm stand on these matters so that those who have put their trust in God will concentrate on the essentials that are good for everyone.
- 8 This is a trustworthy saying. And I want you to stress these things, so that those who have trusted in God may be careful to devote themselves to doing what is good. These things are excellent and profitable for everyone.
- 9 Stay away from mindless, pointless quarreling over genealogies and fine print in the law code. That gets you nowhere.
- 9 But avoid foolish controversies and genealogies and arguments and quarrels about the law, because these are unprofitable and useless.
- 10 Warn a quarrelsome person once or twice, but then be done with him.
- 10 Warn a divisive person once, and then warn him a second time. After that, have nothing to do with him.
- 11 It's obvious that such a person is out of line, rebellious against God. By persisting in divisiveness he cuts himself off.
- 11 You may be sure that such a man is warped and sinful; he is self-condemned.
- 12 As soon as I send either Artemas or Tychicus to you, come immediately and meet me in Nicopolis. I've decided to spend the winter there.
- 12 As soon as I send Artemas or Tychicus to you, do your best to come to me at Nicopolis, because I have decided to winter there.
- 13 Give Zenas the lawyer and Apollos a hearty send-off. Take good care of them.
- 13 Do everything you can to help Zenas the lawyer and Apollos on their way and see that they have everything they need.
- 14 Our people have to learn to be diligent in their work so that all necessities are met (especially among the needy) and they don't end up with nothing to show for their lives.
- 14 Our people must learn to devote themselves to doing what is good, in order that they may provide for daily necessities and not live unproductive lives.
- 15 All here want to be remembered to you. Say hello to our friends in the faith. Grace to all of you.
- 15 Everyone with me sends you greetings. Greet those who love us in the faith. Grace be with you all.

